Coding Interview Grading Template

Use this template to evaluate a candidate consistently after a coding interview.
Adjust point values to fit the role, seniority, and interview format.

Candidate and Interview Details

? Candidate:
? Role/level:
? Interviewer:
? Date:
? Problem:
? Language:
? Interview format:
? Final recommendation: Strong hire / Hire / Lean hire / Lean no hire / No hire

Scoring Summary

Category | Points | Score | Notes

Problem understanding | 15 | |
Algorithm and approach | 20 | |
Code correctness | 25 | |
Code quality and maintainability | 15 | |
Testing and debugging | 10 | |
Communication and collaboration | 10 | |
Follow-up and complexity analysis | 5 | |
Total | **100** | |

Rubric

1. Problem Understanding (15 points)

? Clarifies requirements, inputs, outputs, and constraints.
? Identifies edge cases before or during implementation.
? Restates the problem accurately and confirms assumptions.

Score guidance:

? 13-15: Clear understanding with thoughtful clarifying questions.
? 9-12: Understands the main task but misses some constraints or edge cases.
? 5-8: Requires repeated prompting to identify core requirements.
? 0-4: Misunderstands the problem or solves a materially different task.

2. Algorithm and Approach (20 points)

? Chooses an appropriate data structure and algorithm.
? Explains tradeoffs and justifies the chosen approach.
? Adapts when an initial approach proves insufficient.

Score guidance:

? 17-20: Efficient, well-justified approach with clear tradeoff awareness.
? 13-16: Good approach with minor inefficiencies or gaps in explanation.
? 8-12: Partially correct approach that needs significant interviewer guidance.
? 0-7: Ineffective approach or no coherent strategy.

3. Code Correctness (25 points)

? Produces code that solves the stated problem.
? Handles typical cases and important edge cases.
? Avoids logical errors, off-by-one issues, and unsafe assumptions.

Score guidance:

? 22-25: Correct solution with robust edge-case handling.
? 17-21: Mostly correct with minor defects or omissions.
? 10-16: Partially working solution with meaningful correctness gaps.
? 0-9: Incomplete or incorrect solution.

4. Code Quality and Maintainability (15 points)

? Writes readable, idiomatic code for the chosen language.
? Uses clear names and simple control flow.
? Keeps functions focused and avoids unnecessary complexity.

Score guidance:

? 13-15: Clean, idiomatic, easy-to-maintain implementation.
? 9-12: Understandable code with some style or structure issues.
? 5-8: Hard-to-follow code, duplicated logic, or weak naming.
? 0-4: Code is difficult to reason about or maintain.

5. Testing and Debugging (10 points)

? Tests representative normal cases, boundary cases, and failure cases.
? Uses manual or automated checks effectively.
? Debugs issues methodically when results are unexpected.

Score guidance:

? 9-10: Strong test coverage and systematic debugging.
? 6-8: Tests common cases but misses some important boundaries.
? 3-5: Minimal testing or relies heavily on interviewer hints.
? 0-2: Does not test or cannot debug observed failures.

6. Communication and Collaboration (10 points)

? Thinks aloud and explains decisions clearly.
? Responds constructively to hints, questions, and feedback.
? Balances independent problem solving with collaboration.

Score guidance:

? 9-10: Clear, structured, and collaborative throughout.
? 6-8: Generally clear with occasional gaps in explanation.
? 3-5: Limited communication or difficulty incorporating feedback.
? 0-2: Communication blocks effective evaluation.

7. Follow-up and Complexity Analysis (5 points)

? States time and space complexity accurately.
? Discusses likely bottlenecks and reasonable optimizations.
? Handles follow-up questions about extensions or constraints.

Score guidance:

? 5: Accurate analysis and strong follow-up discussion.
? 3-4: Mostly accurate analysis with small omissions.
? 1-2: Incomplete or incorrect analysis.
? 0: No meaningful complexity discussion.

Interview Notes

Strengths

?
?
?

Concerns

?
?
?

Evidence and Examples

?
?
?

Follow-up Questions Asked

?
?
?

Candidate Questions

?
?
?

Recommendation Rationale

Summarize the decision using observable evidence from the interview. Note any role-specific considerations, signal strength, and areas where more evaluation would be useful.

Recommendation:

Rationale: